

Standard Operating Procedure

Legal Compliance for Imaging Equipment and Stop-Work

«Hospital Name» — Supports AAC.8.a

SOP No.	[Hospital to define]	Version	1.0
Effective Date	_____	Review Frequency	Annual, or on change
Prepared By	Quality Coordinator Name: _____ Signature: _____		
Approved By	Medical Superintendent Name: _____ Signature: _____		

1. Purpose

This SOP describes how «Hospital Name» keeps every radiation-emitting and PC-PNDT-covered imaging modality legally compliant, and what staff must do — including stopping the examination — when a required legal clearance is missing.

2. Scope

Applies to every radiation-emitting imaging modality (requiring AERB clearance) and every ultrasound modality covered by PC-PNDT registration.

3. Responsibility

Radiation Safety Officer (RSO): tracks AERB clearance, dosimeter status, and lead-protection compliance.

Imaging In-Charge: tracks PC-PNDT registration, displays, and reporting obligations.

Any Imaging Staff Member: has the authority — and the duty — to stop an examination when required compliance is missing.

4. Procedure

1. Before every shift, confirm AERB clearance is current for every radiation-emitting modality in use, and that the named RSO's appointment is current. AERB clearance requirements derive from the Atomic Energy (Radiation Protection) Rules, 2004 — see Section 9, Reference 1.
2. Confirm PC-PNDT registration, required displays, and reporting to the competent authority are current for every covered ultrasound modality, per the Pre-Conception and Pre-Natal Diagnostic Techniques (Prohibition of Sex Selection) Act, 1994 — see Section 9, Reference 2.
3. Initiate renewal of any clearance well in advance of its expiry — track expiry dates in the Legal Compliance Status Update Log.
4. Never use equipment when its clearance has lapsed, regardless of clinical urgency for a non-emergency case.

5. Stop-Work Authority

Do not scan or expose a patient when required legal compliance for the modality is missing — AERB clearance and RSO cover for radiation equipment; PC-PNDT registration and displays for covered ultrasound.

Do not use radiation-emitting equipment when mandatory personnel monitoring (dosimeter/TLD) or required lead protection for the examination is unavailable.

Stop-work applies to the imaging examination only — it does not block emergency clinical stabilisation outside the imaging room.

The person who stops tells the Imaging In-Charge or the Radiation Safety Officer the same shift, and the Medical Superintendent if legal clearance is the barrier. Refusing to scan without required checks is not a disciplinary matter.

6. Records

Supported by Records 1–3 of the AAC.8 Required Records pack.

7. Related Documents

- HCO_AAC_8_v2_REWRITE_DRAFT — AAC.8 policy

8. Review

Reviewed annually, or sooner when equipment, modalities, or legal registrations change.

9. References

- Atomic Energy Regulatory Board, Government of India. (2004). Atomic Energy (Radiation Protection) Rules, 2004. <https://www.aerb.gov.in/images/PDF/RPR2004-with-corrigendum.pdf>
- Government of India. (1994). Pre-Conception and Pre-Natal Diagnostic Techniques (Prohibition of Sex Selection) Act, 1994. <https://main.mohfw.gov.in/sites/default/files/PCPNDT%20ACT.pdf>